

digital life doesn't convince you, and the fact that data theft is one of the fastest growing crimes doesn't bother you, how about something as innocent and widespread as a computer virus? No anti-virus setup is foolproof and your system is susceptible to a large number of viruses that data security companies have never even encountered. A detailed survey estimates that a staggering 40 per cent of households are affected by a computer virus and 26 million new strains of malware popped up in 2011 alone! A potentially lethal virus can easily eat up data and corrupt important files. So, while the odds of an earthquake swallowing up your system are relatively low, the probability of a virus affecting your data is quite high. Your data is anything but safe.

Expenses and complications are other reasons people cite for not having a Plan B in place. However, backing up data is hardly expensive, especially when you compare it with the benefits. It's a very cost effective service. Local storage media like external hard drives are available for less than Rs.4,000 and have the capacity to satisfy more than basic data storage needs. When it comes to cloud services, most are available at no cost for lesser (but still sufficient) storage space so if you want to simply create multiple backups of small files then it's a near-perfect option. Online backup services are a bit expensive when compared to the above discussed options, but the former offers high levels of automation, ease of use and can be tailored to suit your needs.

You don't need to be a rocket scientist to efficiently back up data. Using an external drive for backup is as easy as drag-and-drop and cloud-based services are coming up with increasingly simple user interfaces to lure and encourage common PC users to create backups. The UIs are direction driven and usually feature a simple instruction-led process. Contrary to perception, there's no scripting, code-writing or complex installation of third-party software. It's a light and easy procedure.

Then there are those who claim to be too busy to take backups. While it's true that using traditional methods of backup can be time consuming, modern backup services let you save your files in preset intervals and create an automatic backup without interrupting routine. Backing up data is not a process you need to call your IT In-Charge for anymore. It's now become a user-friendly procedure that can be seamlessly integrated into your system security plan. 